

constexpr std::format

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Reply-to: Barry Revzin
<barry.revzin@gmail.com>

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§ 1 Revision History

Since [\[P3391R1\]](#), adding `constexpr` to the integral overloads of `std::to_string` and `std::to_wstring`, which I forgot about earlier. Plus some other wording improvements.

Since [\[P3391R0\]](#), also noted that using the L locale specifier prevents `constexpr` formatting, and a feature-test macro.

§ 2 Introduction

With the adoption of [\[P2741R3\]](#), `static_assert` can take a `std::string`. And the standard library has a very convenient way of producing a `std::string` by way of `std::format`. Except that it's not `constexpr`, so it's not suitable for that purpose. Let's change that.

`std::format` is specified to use type-erasure, by way of a handle type as specified in 28.5.8.1 [\[format.arg\]/10](#):

```
namespace std {  
    template<class Context>  
    class basic_format_arg<Context>::handle {
```

```

const void* ptr_; // expo-
    sition only
void (*format_)(basic_format_parse_context<char_type>&,
    Context&, const void*); // expo-
    sition only

template<class T> explicit handle(T& val) noexcept; // expo-
    sition only

friend class basic_format_arg<Context>; // expo-
    sition only

public:
    void format(basic_format_parse_context<char_type>&, Context& ctx)
        const;
};

```

Such a type was unusable during constant evaluate due to the to cast `ptr_` from `void const*` to some `T const*` in the `format_` function. But with the adoption of [\[P2738R1\]](#), that cast is now allowed. And, if such handles were constructed in place, such construction is now allowed too with the adoption of [\[P2747R2\]](#).

There's really nothing that stands in the way of making `std::format` fully `constexpr`.

Except... there are two categories of types that we cannot immediately support without further work.

§ 2.1 Floating Point

Integral and floating point types are specified to use `std::to_chars`. However, only one overload of `to_chars` is currently declared `constexpr` in 28.2.1 [\[charconv.syn\]](#):

```

constexpr to_chars_result to_chars(char* first, char* last, //
    freestanding
    integer-type value, int base = 10);
to_chars_result to_chars(char* first, char* last, //
    freestanding
    bool value, int base = 10) = delete;
to_chars_result to_chars(char* first, char* last, //
    freestanding-deleted
    floating-point-type value);
to_chars_result to_chars(char* first, char* last, //
    freestanding-deleted
    floating-point-type value, chars_format fmt);
to_chars_result to_chars(char* first, char* last, //
    freestanding-deleted
    floating-point-type value, chars_format fmt,
    int precision);

```

That was added by [\[P2291R3\]](#) which explicitly noted the difficulty of implementing floating point support. That paper was adopted in 2021, and a lot has chanced since then (including multiple floating point

formatting algorithms). So perhaps this decision should be revisited at some point.

§ 2.2 Chrono Types

The chrono types (all of them) are specified to be formatted as if by streaming through `basic_ostringstream<char>` (see 30.12 [\[time.format\]](#)) and absolutely nothing in that type is `constexpr`. That won't work without further changes — most likely by changing how chrono type formatting works rather than by changing `basic_ostringstream`.

§ 2.3 Other Types

There are a few other types in the standard library that have formatters that rely on functionality that is not currently `constexpr`: `stacktrace_entry`, `filesystem::path`, and `thread::id`. Those will remain non-`constexpr` formattable. Additionally, `void const*` cannot be formatted at compile time because it cannot be converted to an address.

§ 2.4 Implementation Experience

The `{fmt}` library has supported compile-time formatting for a while, just through a different API with the format string annotated: as `format_to(out, FMT_COMPILE("x={}", x))`. That implementation even supports floating point types at compile time ([example](#)), but not the chrono types.

Implementing this in `libstdc++` was mostly a matter of marking a lot of functions `constexpr` (which is easy thanks to `-fimplicit-constexpr`). There were only two specific changes I had to make:

1. When assigning into the union, the current implementation [does this](#):

```
template<typename _Tp>
[[__gnu::__always_inline__]]
void
_M_set(_Tp __v) noexcept
{
    if constexpr (derived_from<_Tp, _HandleBase>)
        std::construct_at(&_M_handle, __v);
    else
        _S_get<_Tp>(*this) = __v;
}
```

In that last assignment, `_S_get<_Tp>(*this)` returns the appropriate member of the `union` for the type `_Tp`. That doesn't work during constant evaluation (although it can probably be made to) since there's no active member yet. So I had to change that to be a new function invoked like `_S_set(*this, __v)`.

2. Like `{fmt}`, `libstdc++` has a derived scanner type that is only constructed during constant evaluation time and is only used for parsing. This gets confusing when we also do formatting at compile time, because we don't have that compile-time scanner type, so casting down to it will fail. In `libstdc++`, this is easy to fix though since there is a member pointer to array of types that is just `nullptr` if that scanner isn't used — so we can check that before downcasting.

And with that, [this works](#) (you can see the changes in question on line 3322 for the changed call to `_S_set` and 4392 for the check, at compile-time only, of `_M_types`):

```
template <auto F>
constexpr auto formatted = []{
    static constexpr auto array = []{
        std::array<char, 100> a = {};
        F(a.data());
        return a;
    }();

    return std::string_view(array.data());
}();

static_assert(formatted<[] (char* p){std::format_to(p, "x={}", 42);}> ==
    "x=42");
static_assert(formatted<[] (char* p){std::format_to(p, "x={:}", 42,
    5);}> == "x= 42");
```

§ 3 Proposal

Make `std::format constexpr`, with the understanding that we will not (yet) be able to format floating point and chrono types during constant evaluation time, nor the locale-aware overloads. The facility is still plenty useful even if we can't format everything quite yet!

§ 3.1 Wording

[Drafting note: I'm introducing the term “constexpr-enabled” to describe the standard library formatters that have a `constexpr` format function. This will include most types, but not the floating-point or chrono types mentioned earlier. As such, there are no changes to 30.12 [\[time.format\]](#) here. Also, most of the wording is simply adding `constexpr` to a lot of places — only the synopses are shown in the diff below.]

Add `constexpr` to the integral overloads of `to_string` in 27.4.2 [\[string.syn\]](#):

```
namespace std {
    // [string.conversions], numeric conversions
    int stoi(const string& str, size_t* idx = nullptr, int base = 10);
    long stol(const string& str, size_t* idx = nullptr, int base = 10);
    unsigned long stoul(const string& str, size_t* idx = nullptr, int base
        = 10);
    long long stoll(const string& str, size_t* idx = nullptr, int base =
        10);
    unsigned long long stoull(const string& str, size_t* idx = nullptr,
        int base = 10);
    float stof(const string& str, size_t* idx = nullptr);
    double stod(const string& str, size_t* idx = nullptr);
    long double stold(const string& str, size_t* idx = nullptr);
    - string to_string(int val);
```

```

- string to_string(unsigned val);
- string to_string(long val);
- string to_string(unsigned long val);
- string to_string(long long val);
- string to_string(unsigned long long val);
+ constexpr string to_string(int val);
+ constexpr string to_string(unsigned val);
+ constexpr string to_string(long val);
+ constexpr string to_string(unsigned long val);
+ constexpr string to_string(long long val);
+ constexpr string to_string(unsigned long long val);
  string to_string(float val);
  string to_string(double val);
  string to_string(long double val);

  int stoi(const wstring& str, size_t* idx = nullptr, int base = 10);
  long stol(const wstring& str, size_t* idx = nullptr, int base = 10);
  unsigned long stoul(const wstring& str, size_t* idx = nullptr, int
    base = 10);
  long long stoll(const wstring& str, size_t* idx = nullptr, int base =
    10);
  unsigned long long stoull(const wstring& str, size_t* idx = nullptr,
    int base = 10);
  float stof(const wstring& str, size_t* idx = nullptr);
  double stod(const wstring& str, size_t* idx = nullptr);
  long double stold(const wstring& str, size_t* idx = nullptr);
- wstring to_wstring(int val);
- wstring to_wstring(unsigned val);
- wstring to_wstring(long val);
- wstring to_wstring(unsigned long val);
- wstring to_wstring(long long val);
- wstring to_wstring(unsigned long long val);
+ constexpr wstring to_wstring(int val);
+ constexpr wstring to_wstring(unsigned val);
+ constexpr wstring to_wstring(long val);
+ constexpr wstring to_wstring(unsigned long val);
+ constexpr wstring to_wstring(long long val);
+ constexpr wstring to_wstring(unsigned long long val);
  wstring to_wstring(float val);
  wstring to_wstring(double val);
  wstring to_wstring(long double val);
}

```

And the same in 27.4.5 [\[string.conversions\]](#):

```

- string to_string(int val);
- string to_string(unsigned val);
- string to_string(long val);
- string to_string(unsigned long val);
- string to_string(long long val);
- string to_string(unsigned long long val);
+ constexpr string to_string(int val);
+ constexpr string to_string(unsigned val);
+ constexpr string to_string(long val);

```

```

+ constexpr string to_string(unsigned long val);
+ constexpr string to_string(long long val);
+ constexpr string to_string(unsigned long long val);
  string to_string(float val);
  string to_string(double val);
  string to_string(long double val);

```

7 *Returns:* `format("{} ", val)`.

[...]

```

- wstring to_wstring(int val);
- wstring to_wstring(unsigned val);
- wstring to_wstring(long val);
- wstring to_wstring(unsigned long val);
- wstring to_wstring(long long val);
- wstring to_wstring(unsigned long long val);
+ constexpr wstring to_wstring(int val);
+ constexpr wstring to_wstring(unsigned val);
+ constexpr wstring to_wstring(long val);
+ constexpr wstring to_wstring(unsigned long val);
+ constexpr wstring to_wstring(long long val);
+ constexpr wstring to_wstring(unsigned long long val);
  wstring to_wstring(float val);
  wstring to_wstring(double val);
  wstring to_wstring(long double val);

```

14 *Returns:* `format(L"{} ", val)`.

Add `constexpr` to a lot of places in 28.5.1 [\[format.syn\]](#):

```

namespace std {
  // [format.context], class template basic_format_context
  template<class Out, class charT> class basic_format_context;
  using format_context = basic_format_context<unspecified, char>;
  using wformat_context = basic_format_context<unspecified, wchar_t>;

  // [format.args], class template basic_format_args
  template<class Context> class basic_format_args;
  using format_args = basic_format_args<format_context>;
  using wformat_args = basic_format_args<wformat_context>;

  // [format.fmt.string], class template basic_format_string
  template<class charT, class... Args>
    struct basic_format_string;

  template<class charT> struct runtime-format-string { //
    exposition only
  private:
    basic_string_view<charT> str; //
    exposition only
  public:
-   runtime-format-string(basic_string_view<charT> s) noexcept : str(s) {}

```

```

+ constexpr runtime-format-string(basic_string_view<charT> s) noexcept :
    str(s) {}
    runtime-format-string(const runtime-format-string&) = delete;
    runtime-format-string& operator=(const runtime-format-string&) =
        delete;
};
- runtime-format-string<char> runtime_format(string_view fmt) noexcept {
    return fmt; }
- runtime-format-string<wchar_t> runtime_format(wstring_view fmt) noexcept
    { return fmt; }
+ constexpr runtime-format-string<char> runtime_format(string_view fmt)
    noexcept { return fmt; }
+ constexpr runtime-format-string<wchar_t> runtime_format(wstring_view
    fmt) noexcept { return fmt; }

template<class... Args>
    using format_string = basic_format_string<char,
        type_identity_t<Args>...>;
template<class... Args>
    using wformat_string = basic_format_string<wchar_t,
        type_identity_t<Args>...>;

// [format.functions], formatting functions
template<class... Args>
- string format(format_string<Args...> fmt, Args&&... args);
+ constexpr string format(format_string<Args...> fmt, Args&&... args);
template<class... Args>
- wstring format(wformat_string<Args...> fmt, Args&&... args);
+ constexpr wstring format(wformat_string<Args...> fmt, Args&&... args);
template<class... Args>
    string format(const locale& loc, format_string<Args...> fmt, Args&&...
        args);
template<class... Args>
    wstring format(const locale& loc, wformat_string<Args...> fmt,
        Args&&... args);

- string vformat(string_view fmt, format_args args);
- wstring vformat(wstring_view fmt, wformat_args args);
+ constexpr string vformat(string_view fmt, format_args args);
+ constexpr wstring vformat(wstring_view fmt, wformat_args args);
    string vformat(const locale& loc, string_view fmt, format_args args);
    wstring vformat(const locale& loc, wstring_view fmt, wformat_args args);

template<class Out, class... Args>
- Out format_to(Out out, format_string<Args...> fmt, Args&&... args);
+ constexpr Out format_to(Out out, format_string<Args...> fmt, Args&&...
    args);
template<class Out, class... Args>
- Out format_to(Out out, wformat_string<Args...> fmt, Args&&... args);
+ constexpr Out format_to(Out out, wformat_string<Args...> fmt,
    Args&&... args);
template<class Out, class... Args>
    Out format_to(Out out, const locale& loc, format_string<Args...> fmt,
        Args&&... args);
template<class Out, class... Args>
    Out format_to(Out out, const locale& loc, wformat_string<Args...> fmt,
        Args&&... args);

```

```

template<class Out>
- Out vformat_to(Out out, string_view fmt, format_args args);
+ constexpr Out vformat_to(Out out, string_view fmt, format_args args);
template<class Out>
- Out vformat_to(Out out, wstring_view fmt, wformat_args args);
+ constexpr Out vformat_to(Out out, wstring_view fmt, wformat_args
args);
template<class Out>
    Out vformat_to(Out out, const locale& loc, string_view fmt, for-
mat_args args);
template<class Out>
    Out vformat_to(Out out, const locale& loc, wstring_view fmt, wfor-
mat_args args);

template<class Out> struct format_to_n_result {
    Out out;
    iter_difference_t<Out> size;
};
template<class Out, class... Args>
- format_to_n_result<Out> format_to_n(Out out, iter_difference_t<Out> n,
+ constexpr format_to_n_result<Out> format_to_n(Out out, iter_differ-
ence_t<Out> n,
                                     format_string<Args...> fmt,
                                     Args&&... args);
template<class Out, class... Args>
- format_to_n_result<Out> format_to_n(Out out, iter_difference_t<Out> n,
+ constexpr format_to_n_result<Out> format_to_n(Out out, iter_differ-
ence_t<Out> n,
                                     wformat_string<Args...> fmt,
                                     Args&&... args);
template<class Out, class... Args>
    format_to_n_result<Out> format_to_n(Out out, iter_difference_t<Out> n,
                                     const locale& loc,
                                     format_string<Args...> fmt,
                                     Args&&... args);
template<class Out, class... Args>
    format_to_n_result<Out> format_to_n(Out out, iter_difference_t<Out> n,
                                     const locale& loc,
                                     wformat_string<Args...> fmt,
                                     Args&&... args);

template<class... Args>
- size_t formatted_size(format_string<Args...> fmt, Args&&... args);
+ constexpr size_t formatted_size(format_string<Args...> fmt, Args&&...
args);
template<class... Args>
- size_t formatted_size(wformat_string<Args...> fmt, Args&&... args);
+ constexpr size_t formatted_size(wformat_string<Args...> fmt, Args&&...
args);
template<class... Args>
    size_t formatted_size(const locale& loc, format_string<Args...> fmt,
    Args&&... args);
template<class... Args>
    size_t formatted_size(const locale& loc, wformat_string<Args...> fmt,
    Args&&... args);

```

```
// [format.formatter], formatter
template<class T, class charT = char> struct formatter;

// [format.formatter.locking], formatter locking
template<class T>
    constexpr bool enable_nonlocking_formatter_optimization = false;

// [format.formattable], concept formattable
template<class T, class charT>
    concept formattable = see below;

template<class R, class charT>
    concept const-formattable-range =
        exposition only
        ranges::input_range<const R> &&
        formattable<ranges::range_reference_t<const R>, charT>;

template<class R, class charT>
    using fmt-maybe-const =
        exposition only
        conditional_t<const-formattable-range<R, charT>, const R, R>;

// [format.parse.ctx], class template basic_format_parse_context
template<class charT> class basic_format_parse_context;
using format_parse_context = basic_format_parse_context<char>;
using wformat_parse_context = basic_format_parse_context<wchar_t>;

// [format.range], formatting of ranges
// [format.range.fmtkind], variable template format_kind
enum class range_format {
    disabled,
    map,
    set,
    sequence,
    string,
    debug_string
};

template<class R>
    constexpr unspecified format_kind = unspecified;

template<ranges::input_range R>
    requires same_as<R, remove_cvref_t<R>>
    constexpr range_format format_kind<R> = see below;

// [format.range.formatter], class template range_formatter
template<class T, class charT = char>
    requires same_as<remove_cvref_t<T>, T> && formattable<T, charT>
    class range_formatter;

// [format.range.fmtdef], class template range-default-formatter
template<range_format K, ranges::input_range R, class charT>
    struct range-default-formatter;
    exposition only
```

```

    // [format.range.fmtmap], [format.range.fmtset], [format.range.fmtstr],
    // specializations for maps, sets, and strings
template<ranges::input_range R, class charT>
    requires (format_kind<R> != range_format::disabled) &&
        formattable<ranges::range_reference_t<R>, charT>
    struct formatter<R, charT> : range-default-formatter<format_kind<R>, R,
        charT> { };

template<ranges::input_range R>
    requires (format_kind<R> != range_format::disabled)
    inline constexpr bool enable_nonlocking_formatter_optimization<R> =
        false;

// [format.arguments], arguments
// [format.arg], class template basic_format_arg
template<class Context> class basic_format_arg;

// [format.arg.store], class template format-arg-store
template<class Context, class... Args> class format-arg-store; //
    exposition only

template<class Context = format_context, class... Args>
-   format-arg-store<Context, Args...>
+   constexpr format-arg-store<Context, Args...>
    make_format_args(Args&... fmt_args);
template<class... Args>
-   format-arg-store<wformat_context, Args...>
+   constexpr format-arg-store<wformat_context, Args...>
    make_wformat_args(Args&... args);

// [format.error], class format_error
class format_error;
}

```

Apply the same changes where these functions are referenced.

Change 28.5.2.2 [\[format.string.std\]](#)/17:

- 17 When the L option is used, the form used for the conversion is called the *locale-specific* form. The L option is only valid for arithmetic types, and its effect depends upon the type. A call to format on a given formatter specialization is not a constant subexpression if the locale-specific form is specified.

Mark the *runtime-format-string* constructor `constexpr` in 28.5.4 [\[format.fmt.string\]](#):

```

namespace std {
    template<class charT, class... Args>
    struct basic_format_string {
    private:
        basic_string_view<charT> str; // exposition only

    public:

```

```

    template<class T> constexpr basic_format_string(const T& s);
-   basic_format_string(runtime-format-string<charT> s) noexcept :
    str(s.str) {}
+   constexpr basic_format_string(runtime-format-string<charT> s) noex-
    cept : str(s.str) {}

    constexpr basic_string_view<charT> get() const noexcept { return
        str; }
};
}

```

Add to 28.5.5 [\[format.functions\]](#):

- 0 A call to any of the functions defined in this subclause is a constant subexpression only if each of the used formatter specializations is a constexpr-enabled specialization ([format.formatter.spec]).
- 1 In the description of the functions, operator + is used for some of the iterator categories for which it does not have to be defined. In these cases the semantics of a + n are the same as in [algorithms.requirements].

Add to 28.5.6.4 [\[format.formatter.spec\]](#):

- 2 Let charT be either `char` or `wchar_t`. Each specialization of `formatter` is either enabled or disabled, as described below. A *debug-enabled* specialization of `formatter` additionally provides a public, `constexpr`, non-static member function `set_debug_format()` which modifies the state of the formatter to be as if the type of the *std-format-spec* parsed by the last call to `parse` were `?`. A *constexpr-enabled* specialization of `formatter` has its `format` member function declared `constexpr`. Each header that declares the template `formatter` provides the following enabled specializations:
 - (2.1) — The debug-enabled and `constexpr-enabled` specializations


```

template<> struct formatter<char, char>;
template<> struct formatter<char, wchar_t>;
template<> struct formatter<wchar_t, wchar_t>;
          
```
 - (2.2) — For each charT, the debug-enabled and `constexpr-enabled` string type specializations


```

template<> struct formatter<charT*, charT>;
template<> struct formatter<const charT*, charT>;
template<size_t N> struct formatter<charT[N], charT>;
template<class traits, class Allocator>
    struct formatter<basic_string<charT, traits, Allocator>, charT>;
template<class traits>
    struct formatter<basic_string_view<charT, traits>, charT>;
          
```
 - (2.3) — For each charT, for each `cv-unqualified IntegerT` that is either a signed or unsigned integer type or `bool`, ~~arithmetic type ArithmeticT other than `char`, `wchar_t`,~~

~~char8_t, char16_t, or char32_t~~, a `constexpr-enabled` specialization

```
- template<> struct formatter<ArithmeticT, charT>;  
+ template<> struct formatter<IntegerT, charT>;
```

- (2.x) — For each `charT`, for each `FloatingT` that is a cv-unqualified floating point type, a specialization

```
template<> struct formatter<FloatingT, charT>;
```

- (2.4) — For each `charT`, the `constexpr-enabled` pointer type specializations

```
template<> struct formatter<nullptr_t, charT>;
```

- (2.5) — For each `charT`, the pointer type specializations

```
template<> struct formatter<void*, charT>;  
template<> struct formatter<const void*, charT>;
```

The parse member functions of these formatters interpret the format specification as a *std-format-spec* as described in [format.string.std].

Mark `basic_format_context` as mostly `constexpr` in 28.5.6.7 [format.context] (everything but `locale()`, and repeated in the specification of these functions):

```
namespace std {  
    template<class Out, class charT>  
    class basic_format_context {  
        basic_format_args<basic_format_context> args_;           // exposition  
        only  
        Out out_;                                               // exposition  
        only  
  
        basic_format_context(const basic_format_context&) = delete;  
        basic_format_context& operator=(const basic_format_context&) =  
            delete;  
  
    public:  
        using iterator = Out;  
        using char_type = charT;  
        template<class T> using formatter_type = formatter<T, charT>;  
  
        - basic_format_arg<basic_format_context> arg(size_t id) const  
          noexcept;  
        + constexpr basic_format_arg<basic_format_context> arg(size_t id)  
          const noexcept;  
        std::locale locale();  
  
        - iterator out();  
        - void advance_to(iterator it);  
        + constexpr iterator out();  
        + constexpr void advance_to(iterator it);  
    };  
}
```

```
};
}
```

Mark `range_formatter::format` as `constexpr` in 28.5.7.2 [\[format.range.formatter\]](#) and repeated in its specification:

```
namespace std {
    template<class T, class charT = char>
        requires same_as<remove_cvref_t<T>, T> && formattable<T, charT>
        class range_formatter {
            formatter<T, charT> underlying_;
            // exposition only
            basic_string_view<charT> separator_ = STATICALLY-WIDEN<charT>("
"); // exposition only
            basic_string_view<charT> opening-bracket_ = STATICALLY-
WIDEN<charT>("["); // exposition only
            basic_string_view<charT> closing-bracket_ = STATICALLY-
WIDEN<charT>("]"); // exposition only

        public:
            constexpr void set_separator(basic_string_view<charT> sep)
                noexcept;
            constexpr void set_brackets(basic_string_view<charT> opening,
                                         basic_string_view<charT> closing)
                noexcept;
            constexpr formatter<T, charT>& underlying() noexcept { return un-
                derlying_; }
            constexpr const formatter<T, charT>& underlying() const noexcept {
                return underlying_; }

            template<class ParseContext>
                constexpr typename ParseContext::iterator
                    parse(ParseContext& ctx);

            template<ranges::input_range R, class FormatContext>
                requires formattable<ranges::range_reference_t<R>, charT> &&
                    same_as<remove_cvref_t<ranges::range_reference_t<R>>,
                        T>
                - typename FormatContext::iterator
                + constexpr typename FormatContext::iterator
                    format(R&& r, FormatContext& ctx) const;
        };
}
```

And likewise with `range-default-formatter` in 28.5.7.3 [\[format.range.fmtdef\]](#):

```
namespace std {
    template<ranges::input_range R, class charT>
        struct range-default-formatter<range_format::sequence, R, charT> {
            // exposition only
        private:
            using maybe-const-r = fmt-maybe-const<R, charT>;
            // exposition only
        };
}
```

```

        range_formatter<remove_cvref_t<ranges::range_reference_t<maybe-
const-r>>,
                                charT> underlying_;
    // exposition only

public:
    constexpr void set_separator(basic_string_view<charT> sep)
        noexcept;
    constexpr void set_brackets(basic_string_view<charT> opening,
                                basic_string_view<charT> closing)
        noexcept;

    template<class ParseContext>
    constexpr typename ParseContext::iterator
        parse(ParseContext& ctx);

    template<class FormatContext>
-   typename FormatContext::iterator
+   constexpr typename FormatContext::iterator
        format(maybe-const-r& elems, FormatContext& ctx) const;
};
}

```

And the *range-default-formatter* for maps in 28.5.7.4 [\[format.range.fmtmap\]](#):

```

namespace std {
    template<ranges::input_range R, class charT>
    struct range-default-formatter<range_format::map, R, charT> {
    private:
        using maybe-const-map = fmt-maybe-const<R, charT>;
        // exposition only
        using element-type =
        // exposition only
        remove_cvref_t<ranges::range_reference_t<maybe-const-map>>;
        range_formatter<element-type, charT> underlying_;
        // exposition only

    public:
        constexpr range-default-formatter();

        template<class ParseContext>
        constexpr typename ParseContext::iterator
            parse(ParseContext& ctx);

        template<class FormatContext>
-   typename FormatContext::iterator
+   constexpr typename FormatContext::iterator
            format(maybe-const-map& r, FormatContext& ctx) const;
    };
}

```

And the *range-default-formatter* for sets in 28.5.7.5 [\[format.range.fmtset\]](#):

```

namespace std {
    template<ranges::input_range R, class charT>
    struct range-default-formatter<range_format::set, R, charT> {
    private:
        using maybe-const-set = fmt-maybe-const<R, charT>;
        // exposition only
        range_formatter<remove_cvref_t<ranges::range_reference_t<maybe-
const-set>>,
                                charT> underlying_;

        // exposition only

    public:
        constexpr range-default-formatter();

        template<class ParseContext>
        constexpr typename ParseContext::iterator
        parse(ParseContext& ctx);

        template<class FormatContext>
        -   typename FormatContext::iterator
        +   constexpr typename FormatContext::iterator
            format(maybe-const-set& r, FormatContext& ctx) const;
    };
}

```

And the *range-default-formatter* for strings in 28.5.7.6 [\[format.range.fmtstr\]](#):

```

namespace std {
    template<range_format K, ranges::input_range R, class charT>
        requires (K == range_format::string || K ==
range_format::debug_string)
    struct range-default-formatter<K, R, charT> {
    private:
        formatter<basic_string<charT>, charT> underlying_;
        // exposition only

    public:
        template<class ParseContext>
        constexpr typename ParseContext::iterator
        parse(ParseContext& ctx);

        template<class FormatContext>
        -   typename FormatContext::iterator
        +   constexpr typename FormatContext::iterator
            format(see below& str, FormatContext& ctx) const;
    };
}

```

The `basic_format_arg` class template can be made entirely `constexpr` too, in 28.5.8.1 [\[format.arg\]](#):

```

namespace std {
    template<class Context>
    class basic_format_arg {
    public:
        class handle;

    private:
        using char_type = typename Context::char_type;
        // exposition only

        variant<monostate, bool, char_type,
            int, unsigned int, long long int, unsigned long long int,
            float, double, long double,
            const char_type*, basic_string_view<char_type>,
            const void*, handle> value;
        // exposition only

-       template<class T> explicit basic_format_arg(T& v) noexcept;
        // exposition only
+       template<class T> constexpr explicit basic_format_arg(T& v) noexcept;
        // exposition only

    public:
-       basic_format_arg() noexcept;
+       constexpr basic_format_arg() noexcept;

-       explicit operator bool() const noexcept;
+       constexpr explicit operator bool() const noexcept;

        template<class Visitor>
-       decltype(auto) visit(this basic_format_arg arg, Visitor&& vis);
+       constexpr decltype(auto) visit(this basic_format_arg arg,
            Visitor&& vis);
        template<class R, class Visitor>
-       R visit(this basic_format_arg arg, Visitor&& vis);
+       constexpr R visit(this basic_format_arg arg, Visitor&& vis);
    };
}

```

And the `handle` type introduced in 28.5.8.1 [\[format.arg\]/10](#):

- 10 The class `handle` allows formatting an object of a user-defined type.

```

namespace std {
    template<class Context>
    class basic_format_arg<Context>::handle {
    public:
        const void* ptr_;
        // exposition only
        void (*format_)(basic_format_parse_context<char_type>&,
            Context&, const void*);
        // exposition only
-       template<class T> explicit handle(T& val) noexcept;
        // exposition only
    };
}

```

```

+   template<class T> constexpr explicit handle(T& val) noexcept; //
      exposition only
      friend class basic_format_arg<Context>;           // ex-
      position only
      public:
-   void format(basic_format_parse_context<char_type>&, Context& ctx)
      const;
+   constexpr void format(basic_format_parse_context<char_type>&,
      Context& ctx) const;
  };
}

```

And `basic_format_args` in 28.5.8.3 [\[format.args\]](#):

```

namespace std {
  template<class Context>
  class basic_format_args {
    size_t size_;           // exposition only
    const basic_format_arg<Context>* data_;   // exposition only

    public:
      template<class... Args>
-     basic_format_args(const format-arg-store<Context, Args...>&
        store) noexcept;
+     constexpr basic_format_args(const format-arg-store<Context,
        Args...>& store) noexcept;

-     basic_format_arg<Context> get(size_t i) const noexcept;
+     constexpr basic_format_arg<Context> get(size_t i) const noexcept;
  };

  template<class Context, class... Args>
    basic_format_args(format-arg-store<Context, Args...>) ->
    basic_format_args<Context>;
}

```

And the tuple formatter in 28.5.9 [\[format.tuple\]](#):

```

namespace std {
  template<class charT, formattable<charT>... Ts>
  struct formatter<pair-or-tuple<Ts...>, charT> {
    private:
      tuple<formatter<remove_cvref_t<Ts>, charT>...> underlying_;
      // exposition only
      basic_string_view<charT> separator_ = STATICALLY-WIDEN<charT>("
      ");           // exposition only
      basic_string_view<charT> opening-bracket_ = STATICALLY-
      WIDEN<charT>("("); // exposition only
      basic_string_view<charT> closing-bracket_ = STATICALLY-
      WIDEN<charT>(")"); // exposition only

    public:

```

```

        constexpr void set_separator(basic_string_view<charT> sep)
        noexcept;
        constexpr void set_brackets(basic_string_view<charT> opening,
                                     basic_string_view<charT> closing)
        noexcept;

        template<class ParseContext>
        constexpr typename ParseContext::iterator
        parse(ParseContext& ctx);

        template<class FormatContext>
        -   typename FormatContext::iterator
        +   constexpr typename FormatContext::iterator
            format(see below& elems, FormatContext& ctx) const;
    };

    template<class... Ts>
        inline constexpr bool
        enable_nonlocking_formatter_optimization<pair-or-tuple<Ts...>>
        =
        (enable_nonlocking_formatter_optimization<Ts> && ...);
}

```

Mark the vector<bool>::reference formatter `constexpr` in 23.3.14.2 [[vector.bool.fmt](#)]:

```

namespace std {
    template<class T, class charT>
        requires is_vector_bool_reference<T>
        struct formatter<T, charT> {
        private:
            formatter<bool, charT> underlying_;           // exposition only

        public:
            template<class ParseContext>
            constexpr typename ParseContext::iterator
            parse(ParseContext& ctx);

            template<class FormatContext>
            -   typename FormatContext::iterator
            +   constexpr typename FormatContext::iterator
                format(const T& ref, FormatContext& ctx) const;
        };
}

```

And the container adaptors in 23.6.13 [[container.adaptors.format](#)]:

- 1 For each of queue, priority_queue, and stack, the library provides the following `constexpr-enabled` formatter specialization where *adaptor-type* is the name of the template:

```

namespace std {
    template<class charT, class T, formattable<charT> Container,
            class... U>

```

```

struct formatter<adaptor-type<T, Container, U...>, charT> {
private:
    using maybe-const-container =
        // exposition only
        fmt-maybe-const<Container, charT>;
    using maybe-const-adaptor =
        // exposition only
        maybe-const<is_const_v<maybe-const-container>,
        // see [ranges.syn]
        adaptor-type<T, Container, U...>>;
    formatter<ranges::ref_view<maybe-const-container>, charT> underlying_;
    // exposition only

public:
    template<class ParseContext>
    constexpr typename ParseContext::iterator
    parse(ParseContext& ctx);

    template<class FormatContext>
    - typename FormatContext::iterator
    + constexpr typename FormatContext::iterator
      format(maybe-const-adaptor& r, FormatContext& ctx) const;
};

```

§ 3.2 Feature-Test Macro

Add a new `__cpp_lib_constexpr_format` to 17.3.2 [\[version.syn\]](#):

```
#define __cpp_lib_constexpr_format 2025XXL // also in <format>
```

§ 4 References

[P2291R3] Daniil Goncharov, Karaev Alexander. 2021-09-23. Add Constexpr Modifiers to Functions to_chars and from_chars for Integral Types in Header.

<https://wg21.link/p2291r3>

[P2738R1] Corentin Jabot, David Ledger. 2023-02-13. constexpr cast from void*: towards constexpr type-erasure.

<https://wg21.link/p2738r1>

[P2741R3] Corentin Jabot. 2023-06-16. user-generated static_assert messages.

<https://wg21.link/p2741r3>

[P2747R2] Barry Revzin. 2024-03-19. constexpr placement new.

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[P3391R1] Barry Revzin. 2025-04-15. constexpr std::format.

<https://wg21.link/p3391r1>